

The far-right rallies and counter-protest as resistance : Claiming the street

- Analysis of far-right protest data across Europe (2008-2018).
- Based on the Far-Right Protest Observatory (FARPO) dataset.

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Understanding the FARPO Dataset

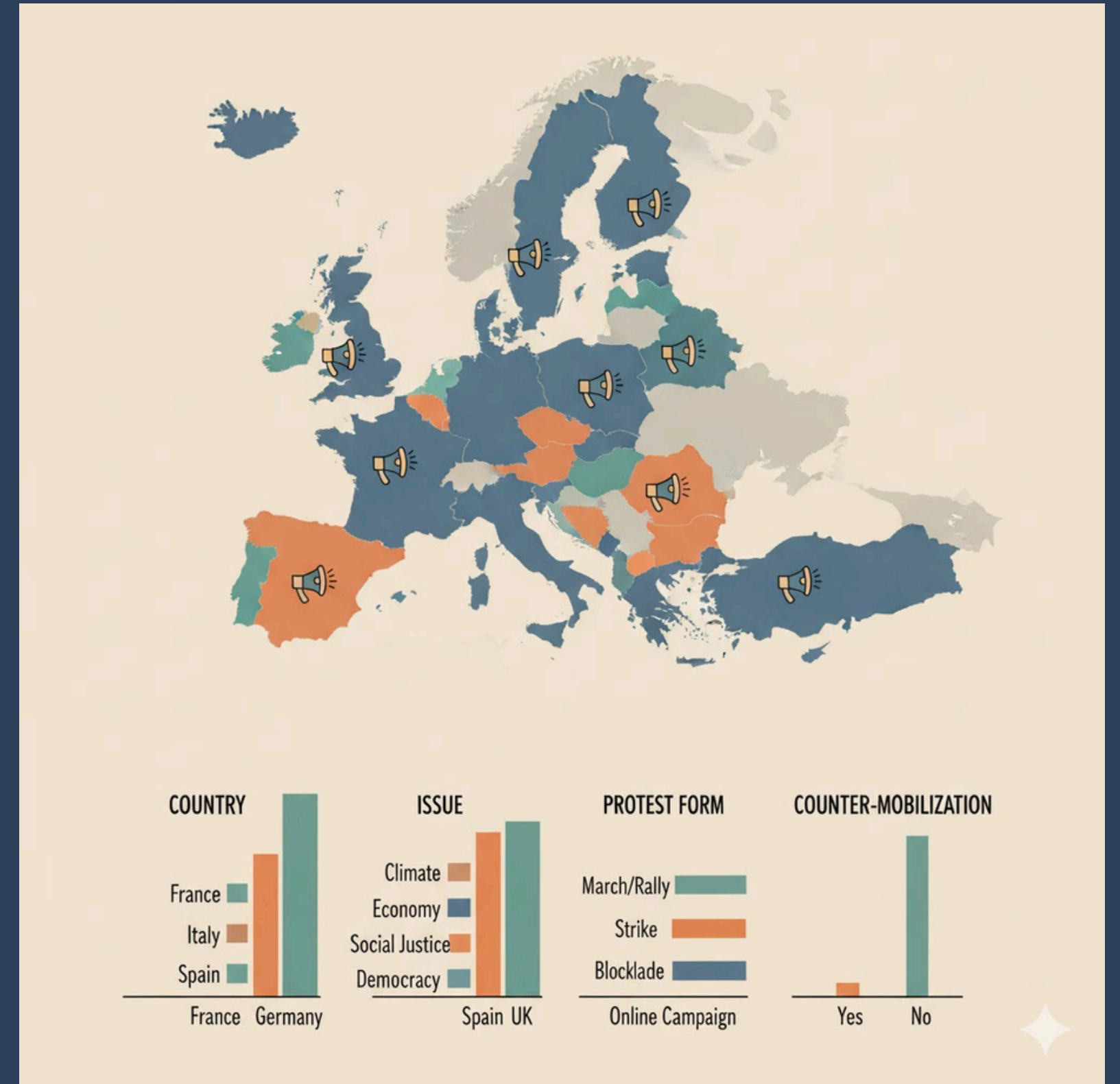
Objective: Test 6 hypotheses about mobilization trends, issues, and counter-mobilization.

Dataset Size

The FARPO dataset includes **5,067 protest events**, meticulously recorded with various features, enabling in-depth analysis of far-right activism trends across Europe.

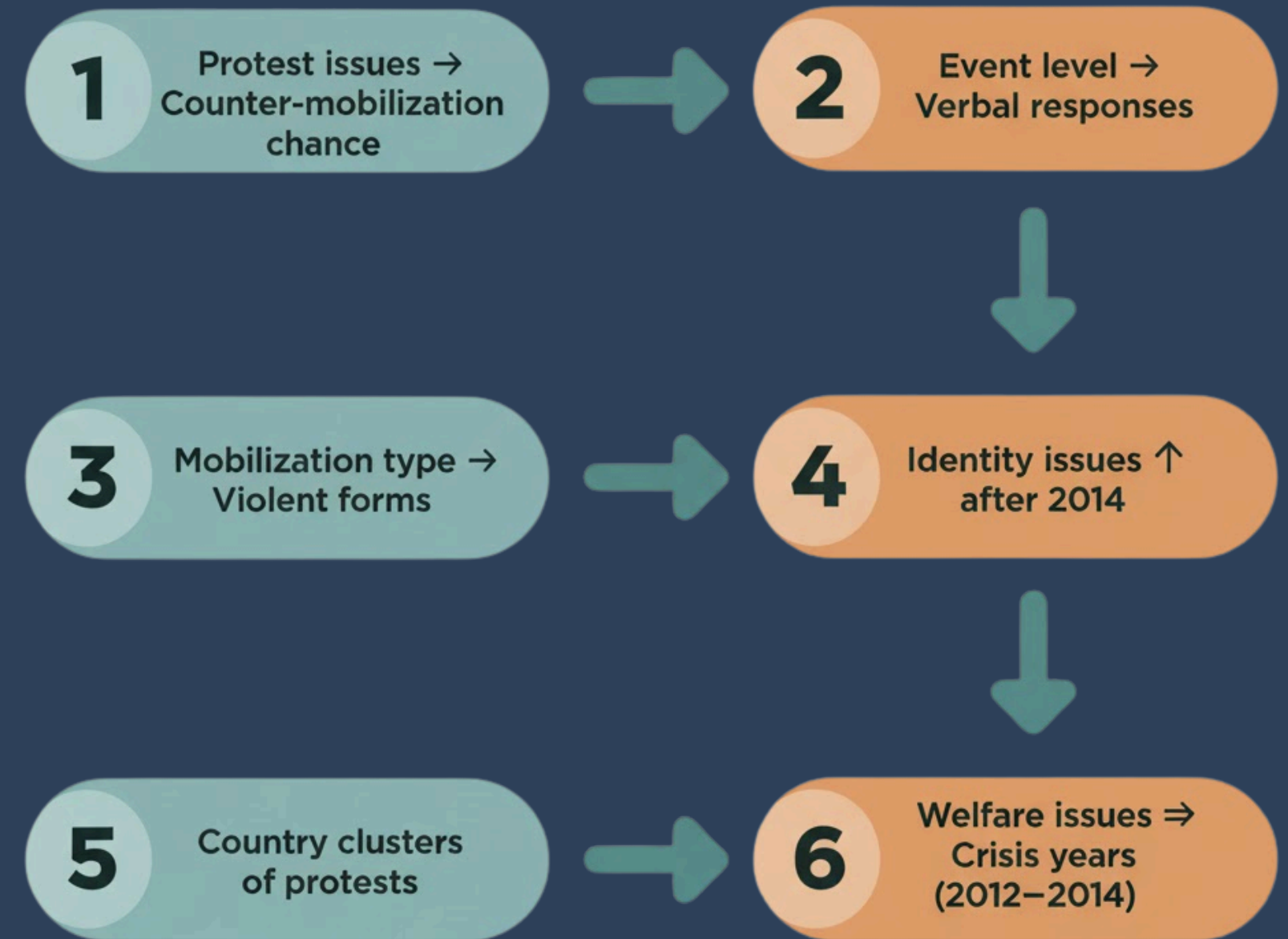
Features Overview

It encompasses **57 features**, including country, issue, and protest form, providing a robust framework to examine the complexities of far-right mobilization and counter-mobilization activities.



Hypotheses Overview

- Event level vs. verbal counter-mobilization.
- Rise of identity-based issues post-2014.
- Country concentration of mobilizations.
- Welfare issues and crisis years (2012–2014).



Data Cleaning & Preprocessing



Irrelevant Columns

Removed irrelevant columns and



Focused on key variables

issue1, counter-mobilization, protest form, event level.



Standardization

Standardized text fields.
& consistent variable naming



Missing Data

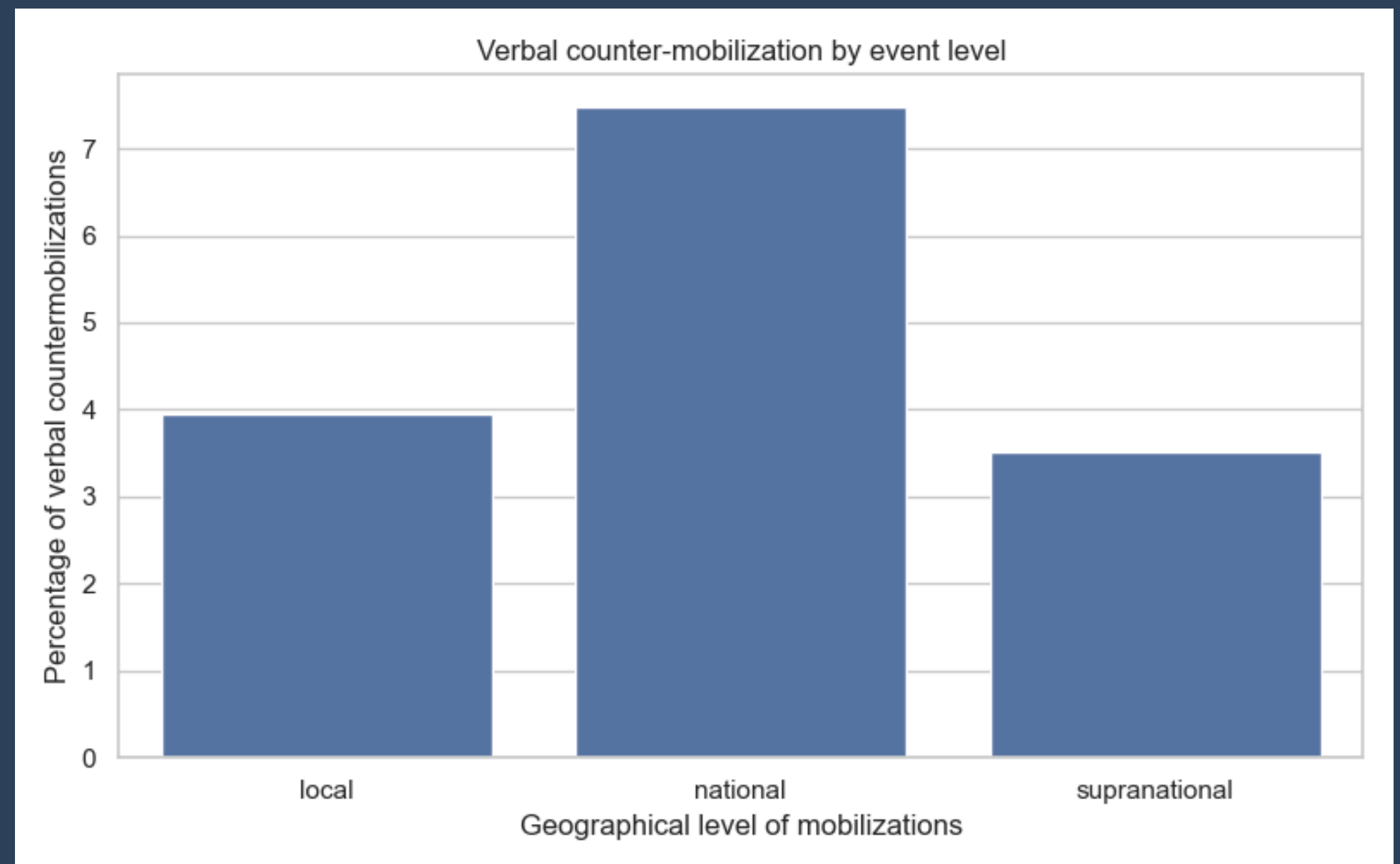
Removed null values

Hypothesis 1 – Event Level & Verbal Counter-Mobilization

National and supranational mobilizations are more likely to feature verbal counter-mobilization

Key Observations:

- National-level protests saw more verbal opposition (~8%) vs. Local (~4%).
- Supranational protests had fewer verbal responses due to limited frequency.
- Hypothesis partially supported.

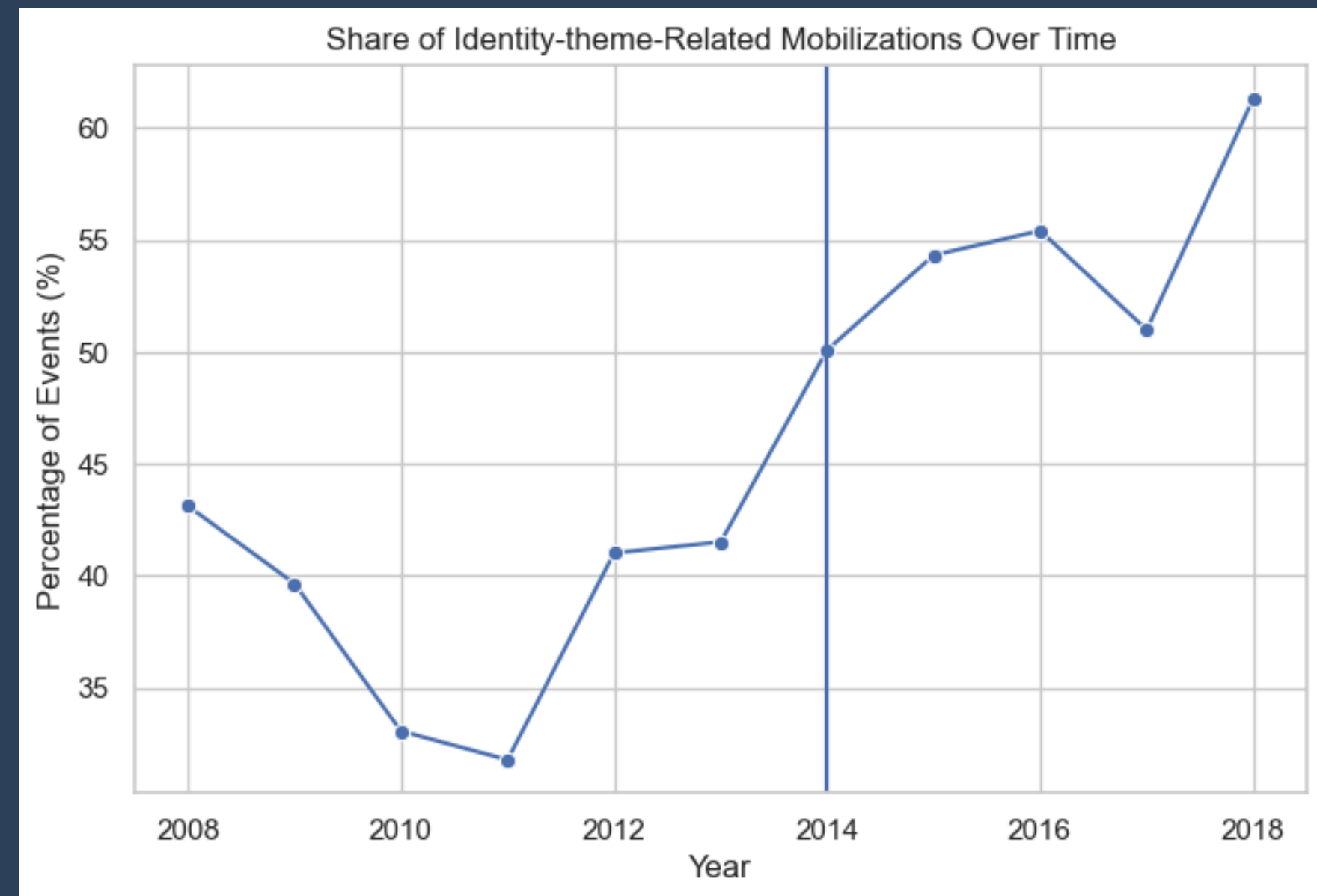


Hypothesis 2 – Identity Issues After 2014

Issues related to Islam, immigration, and identity have become pillars of far-right discourse, especially since 2014.

Key Observations:

- Post-2014: 54.7% of protests focused on Islam, Immigration, Identity.
- Pre-2014: only 38%.
- Indicates post-crisis ideological shift in far-right discourse.

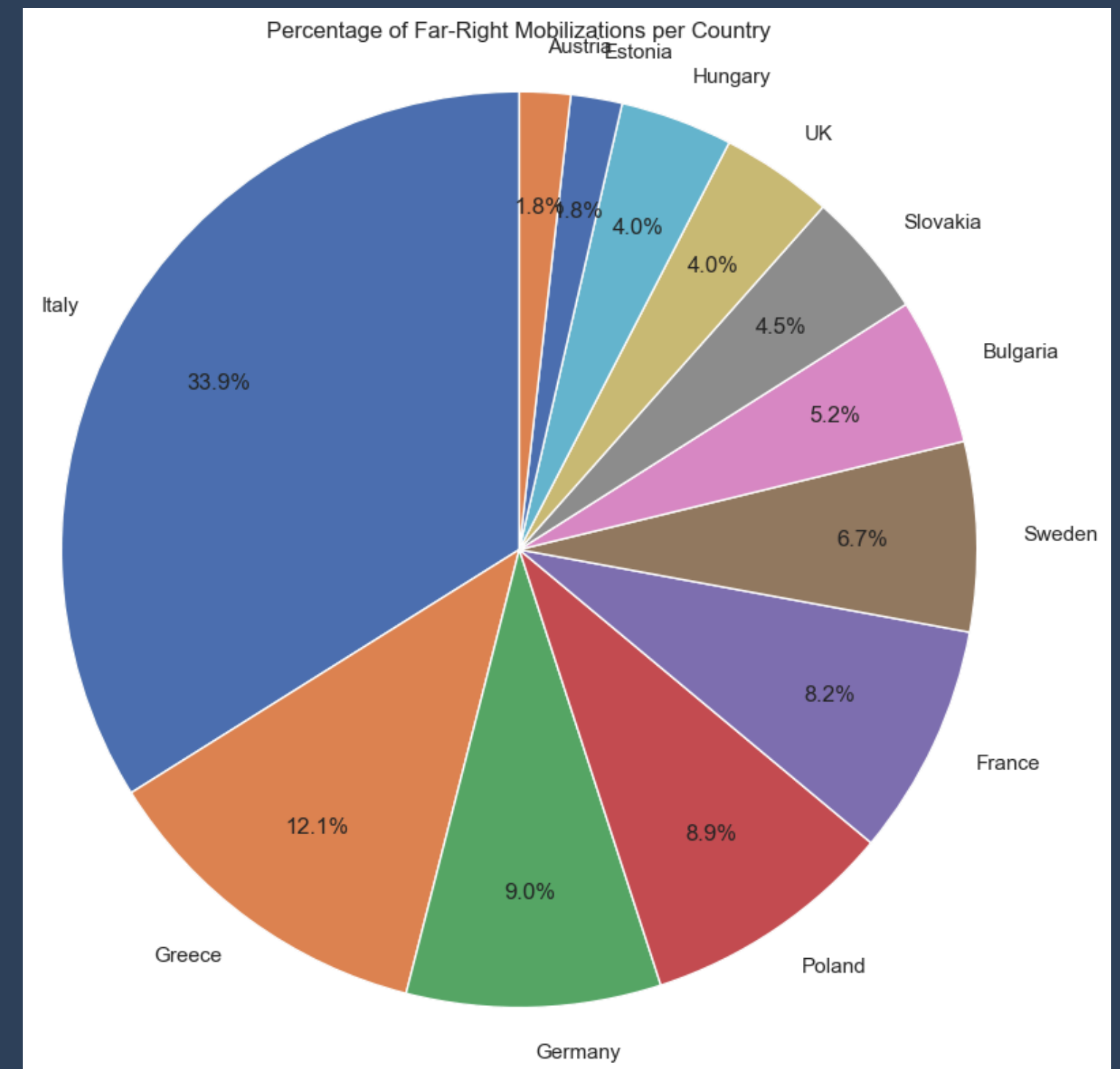


Hypothesis 3 – Geographic Concentration

Majority of FARPO concentrated in fewer countries

Key Observations:

- Top 5 countries (Italy, Greece, Germany, Poland, France) = 72% of all protests.
- Highlights uneven mobilization distribution across Europe.
- Strongly supports hypothesis.

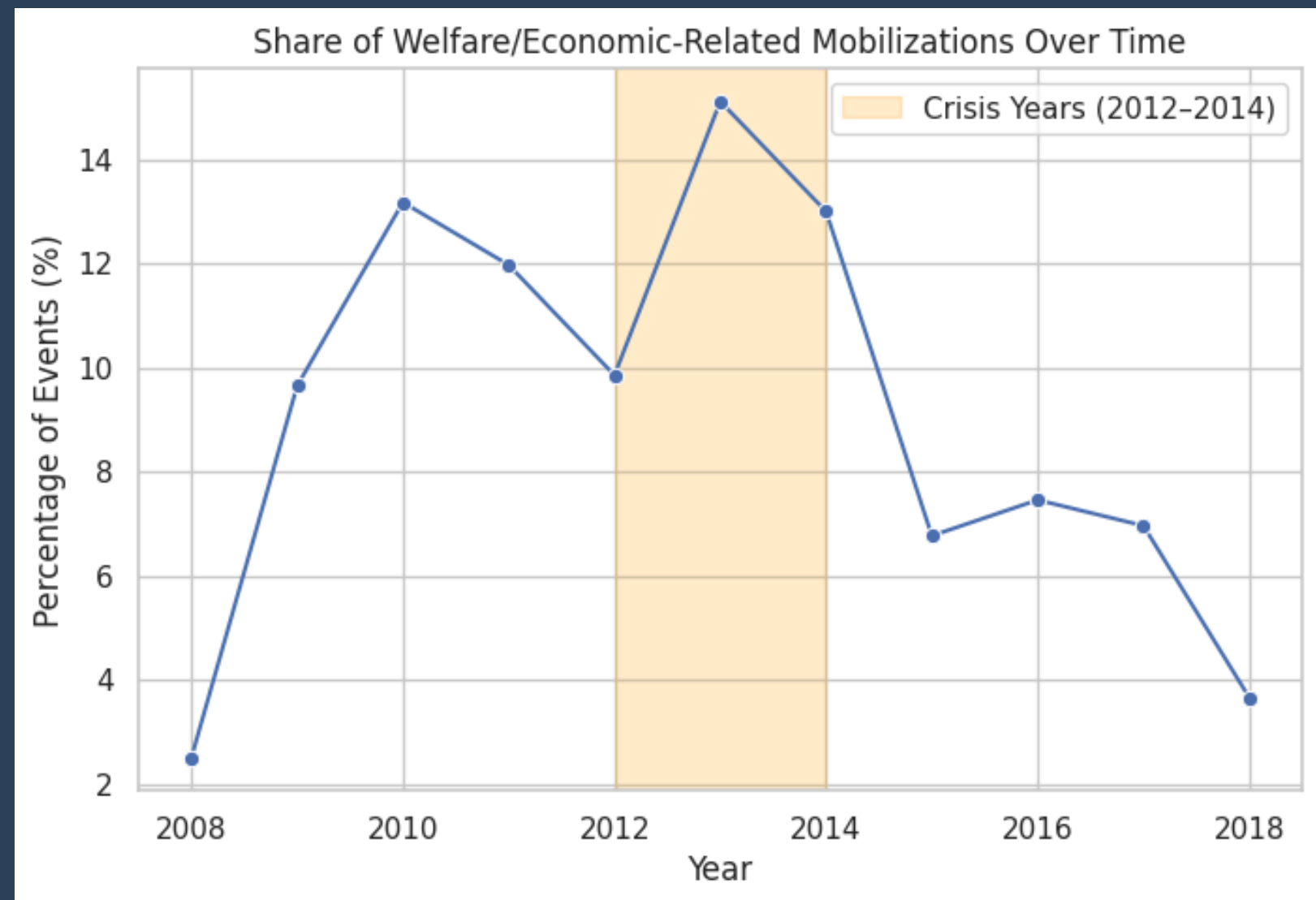


Hypothesis 4 – Welfare Focus During Crisis Years

Except in specific moments of crisis (for example, between 2012 and 2014), welfare issues do not occupy a central place on the far right's mobilisation agenda.

Key Observations:

- Welfare/economic issues peaked (15%) between 2012-2014.
- Matches European debt crisis timeline.
- Declined afterward → identity politics dominated again.



Thank You!

